

“Toggle”. It features a whole pile of tiles that you can pin to the start screen for quick access.

Miscellaneous Tips

The US version of WP7 features an app called Local Scout. It is useful if you're the type who goes around looking for restaurants and other interesting places. The app isn't available in India but to enable it, all you have to do is navigate to settings->"region+language"; scroll down to "Browser and search language settings" and change the language to "English (United States)". The app should now show up on your start screen.

If you don't have Wi-Fi access or a data connection and for some reason you still want to connect your phone to the Internet, you can plug your phone into the PC and start the Zune software. Your phone can now access the Internet if your PC can. Bear in mind that you cannot access the marketplace or images or music or video when connected to the PC.

Long-pressing certain keys while typing will give you more options. For example, long pressing the period key will present you with options such as an exclamation mark or question mark. If you made a mistake while typing, just tapping on the word will select the whole thing and you can delete and rewrite, if you want to edit only a letter or so from the word, long-press in the input bar and you will be presented with a large cursor which you can place anywhere for easy editing.

WP7 comes with a very effective qr code reader in terms of the Bing! Visual Search app. There is a drawback to this however as you cannot read codes if you're not connected to the Internet. To get around this limitation, use a 3rd party app such as red laser for all your scanning needs.

GIT FOR ALL

Git is usually what you call your good-for-nothing neighbour, but the programmers identify it as one of the best revision control system available. One of its central feature is the fact that it's distributed, so each of the contributor has his/her copy of the repository. This may seem counter-productive but it is actually very beneficial, having everything in one place tends to increase bottlenecks and liabilities.

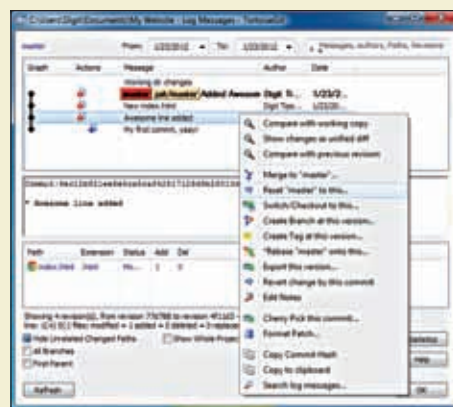
Git is primarily used for maintaining a project's source code. Anything that has mul-

Mac OS X, in case you'd like to work on those platforms.

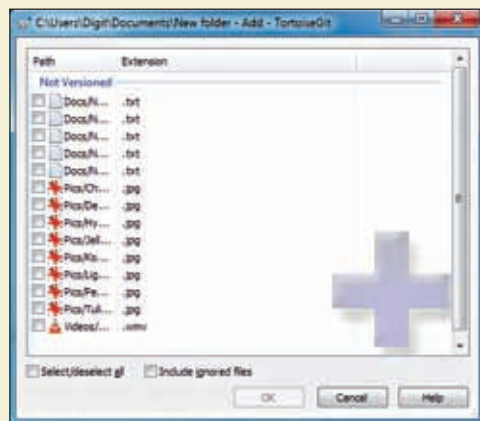
Security in Git

Git shirks away from handling security by itself. It relies on the underlying operating system and communication protocols to handle access control to the

repository. In most cases SSH and HTTPS do the trick. In case you're maintaining a repository at your work and want to access the repository from home, you can do that using SSH. Most of the GUIs work on both protocols so you're assured that your data will remain safe.



You can revert to a particular commit



Stage your files before running commit on them

tiple versions and needs collaboration can be maintained by Git. You can use it to maintain - your resume, your daily budget, your homework, your projects (the non-coding ones also), photos, presentations, documents and so on. Here are a few tips to get you started

GUIs for Git

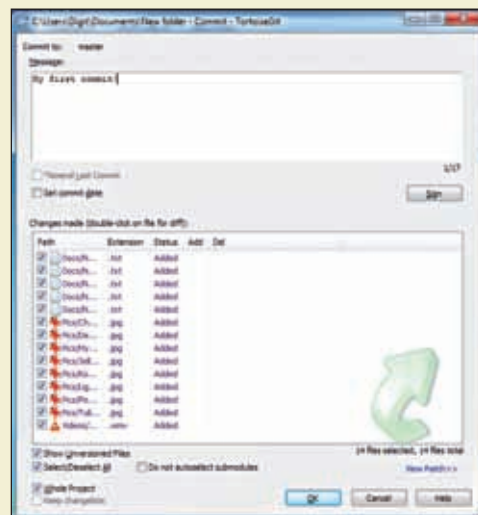
If you're a Windows user and seeing a command-line makes your blood run cold, then you're in for some good news. The first bit of good news is that Git is available for Windows (<http://bit.ly/yzt2rY>) and its not a cygwin port. The second bit of good news is there are a plethora of GUIs available for git such as TortoiseGIT, GitForce, git-cola and Git extensions. There are more GUIs available for Linux and

Sync two folders using Git

Make sure you are running msysgit and TortoiseGit before moving on. You'll also need to configure Git before you can commit data. Simplest way to go about this is to right-click on you desktop and in the context menu that appears, select TortoiseGIT sub-menu and then select "Settings". Select "Config" from the left-side pane in the dialog that follows and enter your name and email address.

Say you've got two folders in two different places, one at work and the

other at home. You can setup Git so that the contents of both the folders are synchronised. You start by navigating to the folder you want to sync and right-click in an empty area to get to the context menu. Inside the context menu select "Git Create repository here...". Add all the files you want into this folder, you can even make sub-folders if you want. Once you're done open the context-menu once again and select the "Add..." from the TortoiseGit submenu. In the dialog select the files that you want to add to the repo, now all the items in the directory are staged. Run commit by opening the context menu again and then selecting "Git commit -> master" in the dialog that follows select all the files that you staged. This repository is now updated and all changes are saved.



Running a commit on the repo